

MODERN INDIAN HISTORY

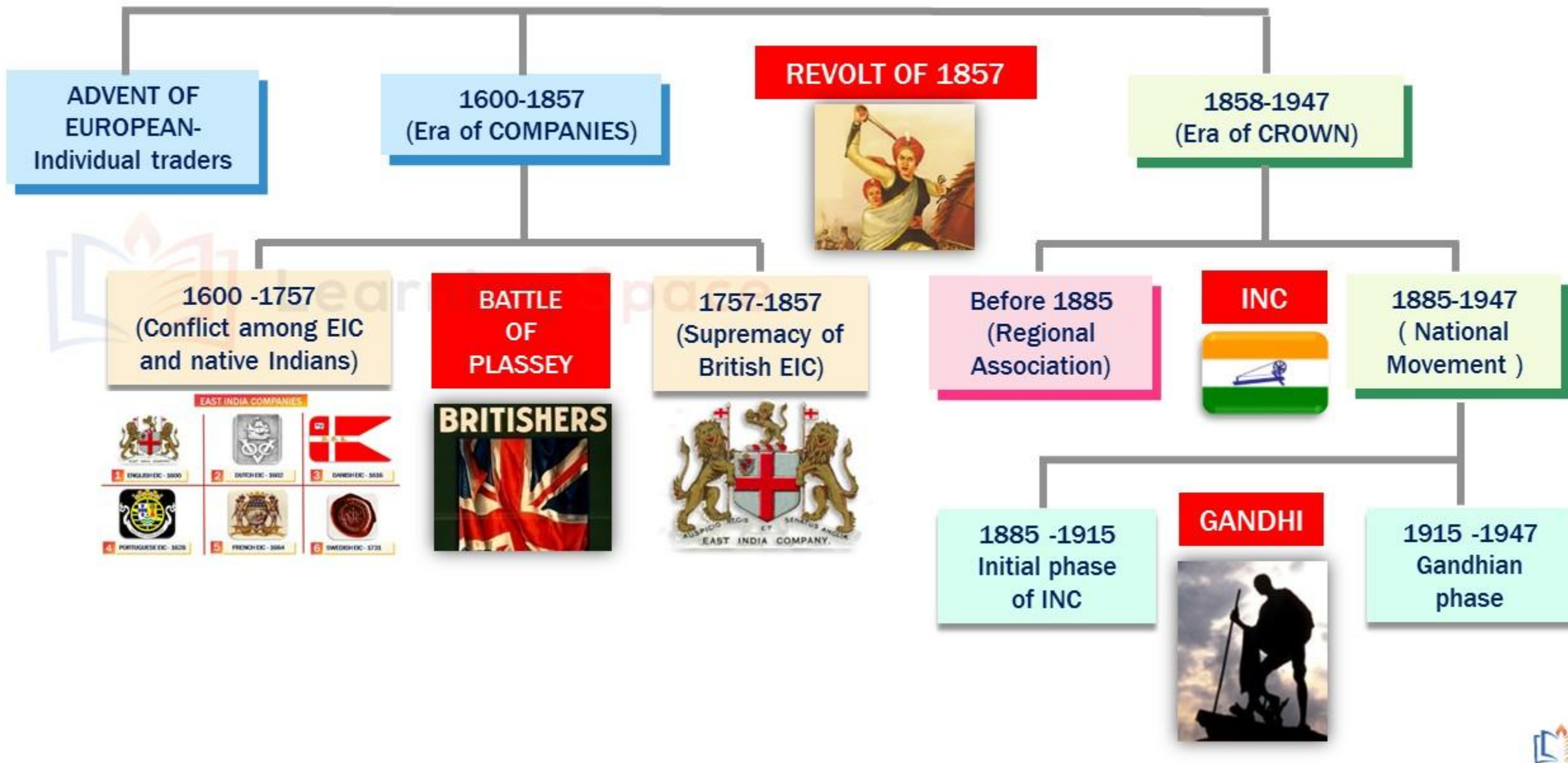


MODULE - 8

**FRENCH EIC-
PART 1**

MODERN HISTORY

DISCOVERY OF INDIA



EUROPEAN TRADERS



1 PORTUGUESE(CALICUT)



2 DUTCH (PULICAT)



3 ENGLISH(SURAT)



4 DANISH(TRANQUEBAR)



5 FRENCH (PONDICHERY)



**FRENCH
EAST INDIA COMPANY**

**ESTABLISHMENT OF
EIC**

**FRENCH SETTLEMENTS
IN INDIA**

**TACTICS
ADOPTED**

**REASON FOR
DECLINE**

**ANGLO-FRENCH
WARS**

**SUPREMACY OF
ENGLISH EIC**

ESTABLISHMENT OF FRENCH EAST INDIA COMPANY

Jean-Baptiste Colbert founded the French East India Company in 1664.



In 1667, under Francis Caron, company established first factory at Surat and second factory at Masulipattanam

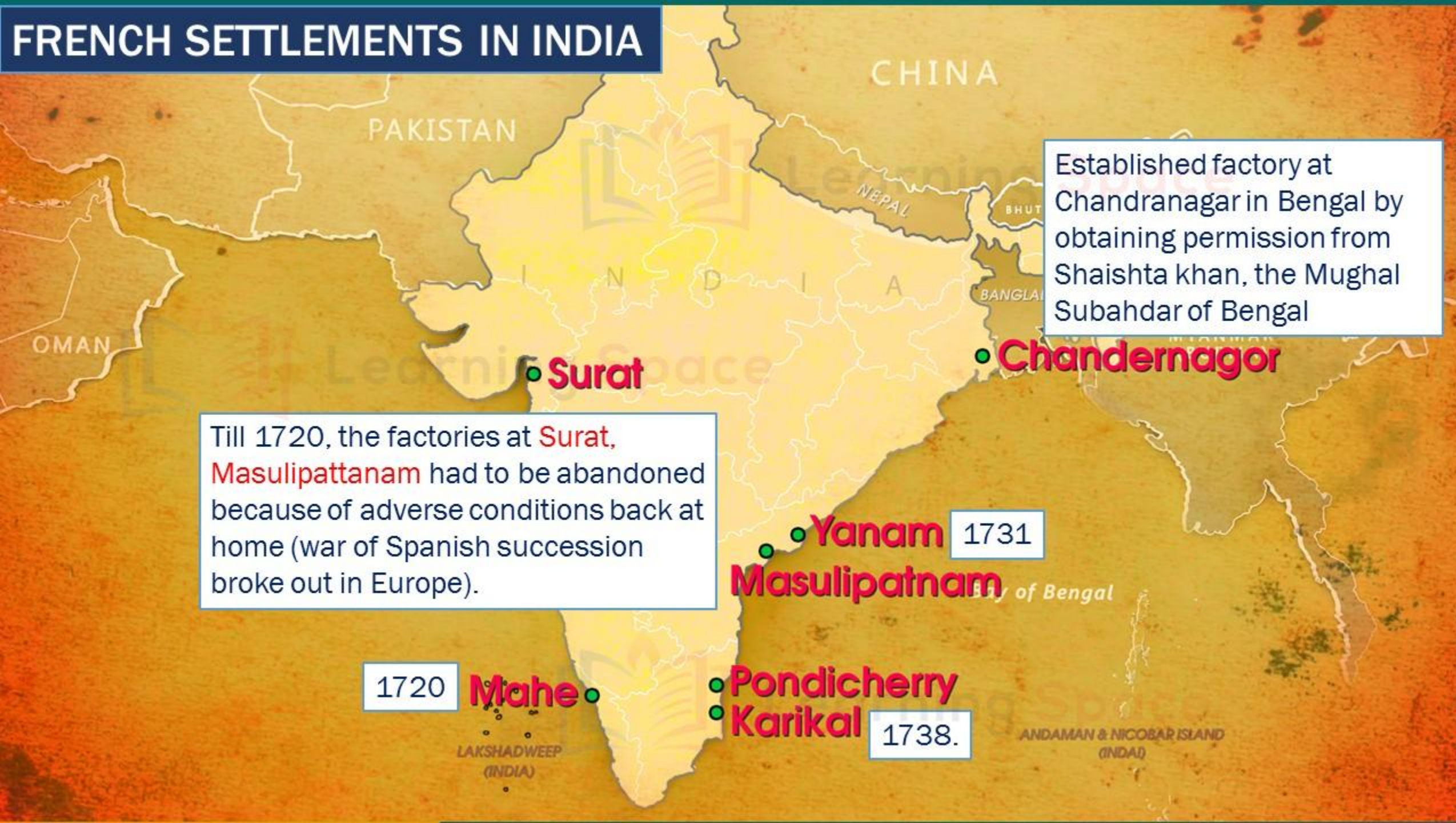


In 1674, François Martin of French East India Company established a trading center at Pondicherry, which eventually became the chief French settlement in India.

French EIC was given monopoly for 25 years.

French were the late comers to join the already well established, complex economic system of production, negotiation, delivery and distribution.

FRENCH SETTLEMENTS IN INDIA



Established factory at Chandranagar in Bengal by obtaining permission from Shaishta khan, the Mughal Subahdar of Bengal

Chandernagor

Till 1720, the factories at **Surat**, **Masulipattanam** had to be abandoned because of adverse conditions back at home (war of Spanish succession broke out in Europe).

Surat

Yanam 1731
Masulipatnam

1720

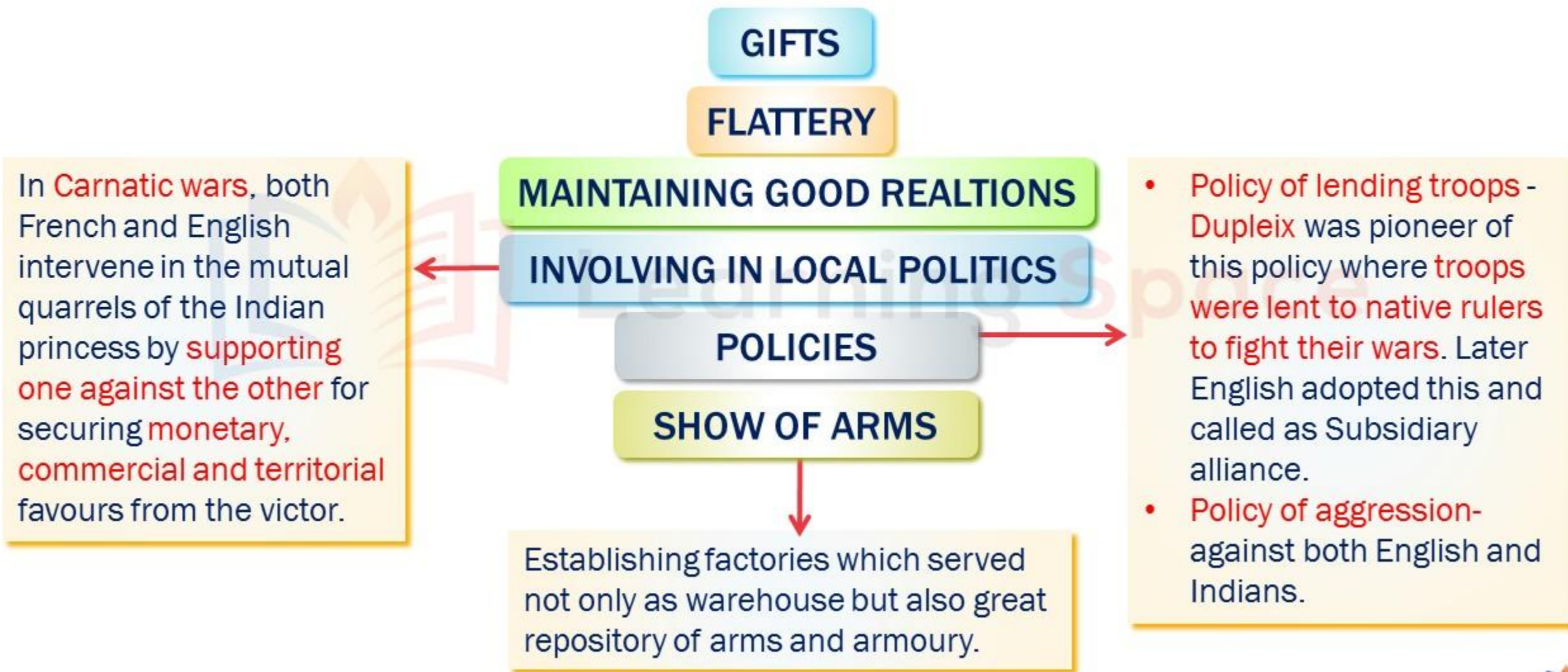
Mahe

Pondicherry
Karikal 1738.

LAKSHADWEEP (INDIA)

ANDAMAN & NICOBAR ISLAND (INDIA)

TACTICS ADOPTED BY THE FRENCH EAST INDIA COMPANY TO CONSOLIDATE THEIR EMPIRE



WHO WAS DUPLIEX?



- Dupleix was French governor – **ambitious** administrator, diplomat, leader, having broad **vision of having greater territorial control**.
- Dupleix was, in fact, the **originator of the practice of lending troops** (later called as subsidiary alliance) in India. He placed a **French army at Hyderabad**.

Why Dupleix wanted to expand French empire?

- **Pondicherry facing several problems**- Maratha invasion, famine, uncultivated land.
- **Drastic cut in expenditure** in India as priority was given to France colonies in America



WHY DUPLIEX FAILED?

Over-sanguine temperament
i.e **over optimistic**.

Dupleix was **not a man of action**:
he planned a campaign, directed his lieutenants, but **never led an army** in the battlefield like Lawrence or Clive.

Autocratic behavior
sometimes lead to quarrel.

He was making personal fortune by **involving in private trade**, added to this Carnatic wars under Dupliex were big set back for the company.

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REASONS FOR THE DECLINE OF FRENCH EIC

1 REASONS WITHIN THE COMPANY

INTERNAL WEAKNESS

- French EIC suffered from lack of vision.
- Lack of adequate vessels and experienced captain and skilled Sailors.
- Gave more importance to territorial expansion rather than commercial interest.
- Though their trade expanded but their expenditure was more than its income.

GOVERNMENT INTERFERENCE

Company lack functional autonomy and independence in decision taking.

CONFLICTING INTEREST

- Unlike other EICs French share holders were mostly nobles and not merchants. They were most interested in short term dividends.
- Conflict among French officials themselves for example – La Bourdonnais , French governor of Mauritius, wanted to act with complete independence, while Governor General Dupleix considered himself superior.

REASONS FOR THE DECLINE OF FRENCH EIC

2 WARS

WAR FOR COLONISATION

- Company was entangled in the colonization of Madagascar in Africa (which was failed adventure) to secure the sea lanes to India.
- Meanwhile it also lost substantial market share to “foreign businesses”.

EUROPEAN WARS

- A series of wars with Great Britain and other European major powers during the 18th century and early 19th century diverted their attention and resulted in France losing nearly all of its conquests.

ANGLO-FRENCH WAR

- After Second Carnatic war, Duplex was called by French government. Successor of Duplex were not so ambitious and visionary.
- Defeat of French at Wandiwash (1760) was death blow to French power.

Further attempts were made to revive the company in 1785, but these steps were thwarted by the events of French revolution. France rebuilt a new empire mostly after 1850, concentrating chiefly in Africa as well as Indochina and the South Pacific.

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ENGLISH EIC

Private in character and thus could take instant decisions when needed without waiting for the approval of the government

Commercially Superior and better financial Position

English received supplies of food and money from Bengal, recruits of men from Europe and grain from their northern settlements

NATURE OF COMPANY

ECONOMY

ACCESS TO RESOURCES

FRENCH EIC

Controlled and regulated by Government which itself was suffering from corruption, inefficiency and instability.

French subordinated their Commercial Interest to Territorial Ambitions which made company short of funds.

French could receive nothing but had to extract everything from the colonies which were not sufficient.

ENGLISH EIC

Superior Settlements of British like Calcutta, Bombay and Madras while French had Pondicherry.

British had many capable and able men like Robert Clive, Stringer Lawrence and Sir Eyre Coote.

Naval Supremacy and Naval Bases in Indian ocean helped to cut off vital sea link between French possession in India and France .

SETTLEMENTS

LEADERSHIP

NAVAL CAPABILITY

FRENCH EIC

No strong settlements in India. French economy saw more trade profit from West Indies than India.

Only Dupleix was strong but even he was recalled by government. Mistakes of Lally—He lacked the foresight and statesmanship of Dupleix.

English navy was much superior than French.

Because of these factors, English were constantly strengthened, the second was constantly weakened. Further, Carnatic wars proved to be a serious set back for French rule in India and paved way for the establishment of the British Empire in India.

- Q** With reference to the entry of European powers into India, which one of the following statements is not correct? [2003]
- (a) The Portuguese captured Goa in 1499
 - (b) The English opened their first factory in South India at Masulipatam
 - (c) In Eastern India, the English Company opened its first factory in Orissa in 1633
 - (d) Under the leadership of Dupleix, the French occupied Madras in 1746

ANSWER (a) The Portuguese captured Goa in 1499.

Q Who among the following Europeans were the last to come to pre-independence India as traders? [2007]

- (a) Dutch
- (b) English
- (c) French
- (d) Portuguese

ANSWER (c) French

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